

28 Jun 2026 18:04:48 ET | 15 pages

Greater China Semiconductors

Apple's Reported Interest in CXMT Memory a Strong Validation of the Company's Technological Progress

CITI'S TAKE

FT reported over the weekend that Apple is seeking U.S. government approval to source memory from CXMT, a leading Chinese DRAM maker currently included on the Pentagon 1260H Chinese Military Company List. While the approval outcome remains uncertain, Apple's consideration already provides a strong endorsement of CXMT's technological progress, in our view. Such validation shifts CXMT from a 'China domestic substitution story' towards a 'credible global No.4 DRAM maker'. We expect the news to be positive for CXMT and its supply chain, including the equipment vendors and OSAT providers. Within our coverage we prefer ASMPT and JCET.

Apple reportedly seeking approval to buy memory from CXMT — News reported Apple is lobbying the Trump administration for approval to buy DRAM from CXMT ([Financial Times](#), Jun 27th) amid surging memory costs. CXMT is currently on the Pentagon's 1260H Chinese Military Company List. While 1260H does not bar U.S. companies from purchasing CXMT DRAM, Apple is seeking policy comfort as CXMT may later be subject to tighter restrictions, such as the BIS Entity List.

Apple's 'stamp of approval' positive for CXMT/supply chain — We believe securing approval to procure CXMT memory could prove challenging given the current U.S. political climate. However, Apple's consideration of CXMT is a strong validation of CXMT's product reliability and the severity of the memory shortage. CXMT LPDDR5X (12Gb/16Gb die capacity) reaches speed of 10667Mbps, potentially addressable to high-end mobile, tablet, and notebook applications. Regardless of whether Apple gets the purchase approval, its consideration of CXMT as a potential supplier shifts market perception of CXMT from a **domestic substitution play** to a **credible global No.4 DRAM maker**. We view the news as positive for CXMT and its supply chain, such as equipment vendors and OSAT providers.

Prefer ASMPT, JCET — We prefer ASMPT (back-end equipment) given: 1) TCB and advanced packaging demand upside; 2) rising OSAT capex; and 3) industry shifting focus towards the back end. We see broadening opportunities in TCB and photonics and expect shares to re-rate beyond its historical range. We [recently updated our forecast for the 3 China OSATs](#) (JCET, TFME, and TSHT) and raised TPs to reflect the strong sector re-rating. JCET is our top pick given its high advanced packaging exposure (60-70% revenue), strong capability (2.5D, 3D, memory), and diverse customer base.

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

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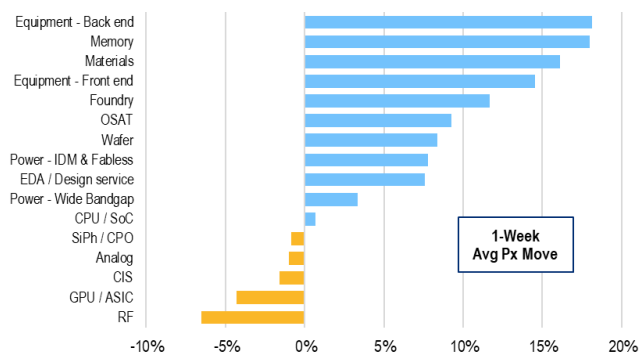
Figure 1. Share Price Movement by Sector

26-Jun-2026	1D	1W	1M	3M	6M	12M
Foundry	-2.6%	11.7%	20.3%	97.1%	86.7%	234.8%
OSAT	-2.2%	9.3%	8.5%	86.5%	102.2%	154.4%
Equipment - Front end	2.3%	14.5%	39.2%	101.4%	102.4%	239.6%
Equipment - Back end	1.7%	18.1%	34.7%	129.5%	206.6%	446.9%
CPU / SoC	-3.6%	0.7%	-5.4%	33.8%	40.7%	74.7%
GPU / ASIC	-9.4%	-4.3%	2.5%	66.5%	31.2%	255.8%
Memory	-1.2%	18.0%	30.3%	131.8%	201.2%	563.8%
SiPh / CPO	-8.6%	-0.8%	23.3%	97.1%	231.8%	780.9%
Analog	-3.4%	-1.0%	11.6%	76.6%	88.2%	113.3%
Power - IDM & Fabless	-2.2%	7.8%	16.9%	69.4%	79.9%	135.2%
Power - Wide Bandgap	-1.5%	3.3%	-6.0%	65.3%	40.0%	114.6%
CIS	-2.2%	-1.6%	-13.3%	2.1%	-10.7%	-11.7%
RF	-4.8%	-6.5%	-10.0%	4.4%	5.1%	26.9%
EDA / Design service	1.2%	7.6%	3.3%	37.0%	46.1%	101.0%
Wafer	7.3%	8.4%	31.4%	88.9%	76.4%	105.4%
Materials	2.7%	16.1%	42.1%	84.0%	145.4%	241.7%

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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

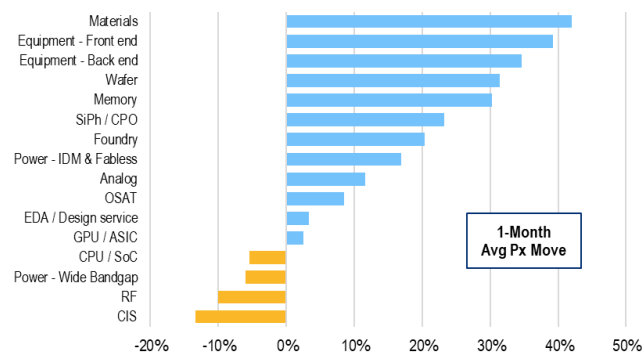
Figure 2. Share Price Movement – 1 Week



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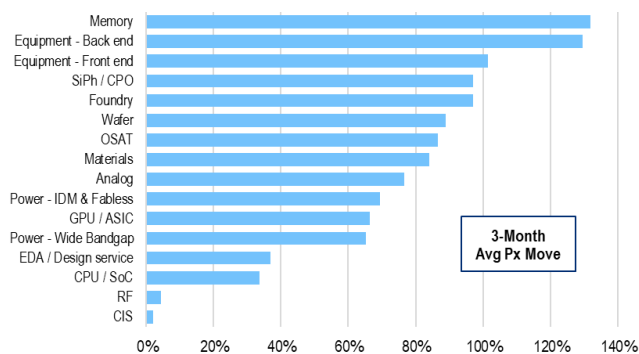
Figure 3. Share Price Movement – 1 Month



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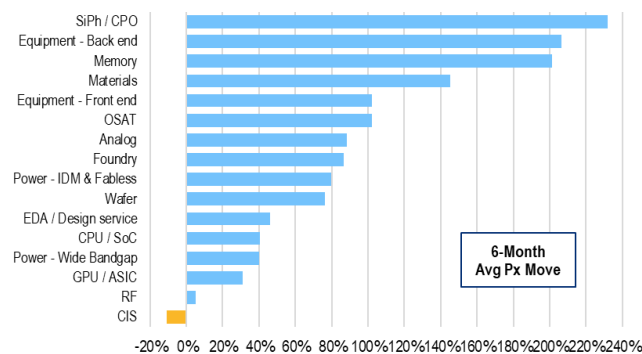
Figure 4. Share Price Movement – 3 Months



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Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 5. Share Price Movement – 6 Months



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[Greater China Semiconductors:Sector Re-Rating Lifts Valuations Across the Board; Model Update](#)

[JCET Group \(600584.SS\):JCET's New Rmb7.8bn Investment Further Strengthens Its Advanced Packaging Leadership](#)

ASMPT

(0522.HK; HK\$195.1; 1; 26 Jun 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price of HK\$180 is based on peak valuation of 37x 2027E P/E. We view the peak valuation as justified because we expect strong revenue and earnings recovery driven by: 1) AI-driven advanced packaging order wins, including TCB for HBM and CoW applications; and 2) ongoing recovery of mainstream SEMI and SMT. Potential sales of SMT business could solidify its market position as a leading provider of advanced packaging solutions, leading to valuation re-rating beyond its historical range.

Risks

Downside risks to our target price being achieved include: 1) a slowdown in AI infrastructure outlook with delayed investment; 2) TCB market share loss at key customers; 3) reduced TCB demand due to alternative technologies, such as hybrid bonding; 4) intensifying industry competition; and 5) export restriction extending to back-end equipment.

JCET Group

(600584.SS; Rmb100.89; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00)

Valuation

We set our target price for JCET at Rmb110 based on a 6.0x 2027E P/B. We believe the China OSAT industry is entering an unprecedented upcycle driven by AI proliferation, tightening industry supply, and growing emphasis on advanced packaging, thus awarding JCET a premium valuation as a key enabler for advanced packaging. We expect industry capacity utilization to remain tight given the robust demand.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) advanced packaging expansion outpacing demand growth, especially given challenges at the front-end; 2) memory makers internalizing back-end packaging operations; 3) falling utilization after industry capacity expansion; 4) geopolitical tensions reducing demand for JCET's overseas operations; 5) US export restrictions limiting supply of back-end equipment.

Tianshui Huatian

(002185.SZ; Rmb22.56; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00)

Valuation

We set our target price for TSHT at Rmb23.5 based on a 4.0x 2027E P/B. We believe the China OSAT industry is entering an unprecedented upcycle driven by AI proliferation, tightening industry supply, and growing emphasis on advanced packaging, thus awarding TSHT a premium valuation over its

historical range. We expect industry capacity utilization to remain tight given the robust demand.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) AI capex slowdown casting concerns over subsequent OSAT demand; 2) falling utilization after industry capacity expansion; 3) geopolitical tensions reducing demand for TSHT's overseas operations; 4) US export restrictions limiting supply of back-end equipment.

TongFu Microelectronics

(002156.SZ; Rmb71.6; 1; 26 Jun 26; 15:00)

Valuation

We set our target price for TFME at Rmb80 based on a 6.5x 2027E P/B. We believe the China OSAT industry is entering an unprecedented upcycle driven by AI proliferation, tightening industry supply, and growing emphasis on advanced packaging, thus awarding TFME a premium valuation as a key enabler for advanced packaging. TFME is also positioned for a strong growth trajectory supported by robust demand from key customer AMD.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include: 1) market share loss at the key customer for exclusion of AI-related business; 2) memory makers internalizing back-end packaging operations; 3) falling utilization after industry capacity expansion; 4) geopolitical tensions reducing demand for TFME's overseas operations; 5) US export restrictions limiting supply of back-end equipment.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

ASMP (0522.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	26-Jul-23 21:43:15	2	*85.00	78.46
2	25-Oct-23 19:24:43	*1	85.00	67.92
3	28-Feb-24 17:15:12	1	*120.00	90.64
4	24-Apr-24 15:46:35	1	*140.00	100.84
5	24-Jul-24 08:56:09	1	*110.00	87.21

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
6	31-Oct-24 04:34:18	1	*105.00	84.08
7	26-Feb-25 12:15:35	1	*75.00	63.47
8	01-May-25 13:33:57	1	*65.00	51.73
9	23-Jul-25 13:41	1	*75.00	62.91
10	11-Aug-25 11:00:54	1	*85.00	69.88

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
11	31-Oct-25 03:41:57	1	*100.00	81.63
12	21-Jan-26 18:19:50	1	*125.00	101.34
13	04-Mar-26 15:09:09	1	*145.00	107.51
14	22-Apr-26 15:53:46	1	*180.00	151.51

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

JCET Group (600584.SS)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	27-Aug-23 19:18:26	1	*40.00	29.81
2	27-Nov-23 04:47:04	1	*45.00	30.88
3	30-Apr-24 03:51:38	1	*40.00	25.77

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
4	25-Aug-24 23:35:27	1	*44.00	30.57
5	22-Jan-25 13:39:33	1	*50.00	40.81
6	20-Jun-25 02:02:03	1	*42.00	31.54

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
7	21-Jun-26 23:19:33	1	*110.00	83.03

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

TongFu Microelectronics (002156.SZ)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	27-Nov-23 04:47:04	1	*26.00	23.00
2	19-Jun-24 03:13:06	1	*28.00	24.78

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
3	22-Jan-25 13:39:33	1	*34.00	28.87
4	20-Jun-25 02:02:03	1	*30.00	23.59

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	05-Nov-25 18:43:02	1	*48.00	40.16
6	21-Jun-26 23:19:33	1	*80.00	68.27

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tianshui Huatian (002185.SZ)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	27-Nov-23 04:47:04	1	*11.00	9.00
2	22-Jan-25 13:39:33	1	*14.00	11.43

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
3	20-Jun-25 02:02:03	1	*11.50	8.76
4	21-Jun-26 23:19:33	1	*23.50	19.61

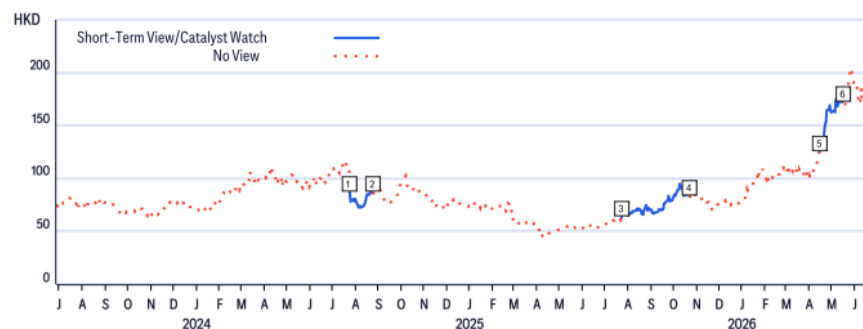
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

ASMPT (0522.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	24-Jul-24 04:56:09	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	87.21
2	23-Aug-24 14:19:04	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	86.26

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	23-Jul-25 09:13:41	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	62.91
4	22-Oct-25 00:34:21	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	83.17

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	14-Apr-26 00:41:45	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	124.93
6	15-May-26 00:28:53	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	172.00

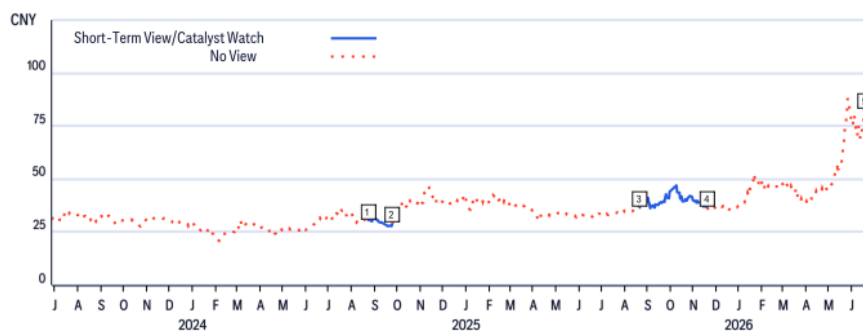
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

JCET Group (600584.SS)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	25-Aug-24 19:35:27	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	30.57
2	24-Sep-24 23:26:37	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	29.00
3	21-Aug-25 08:12:51	Add STV	Downside	90 Days	36.58
4	19-Nov-25 21:14:59	Remove STV	Downside	90 Days	36.59
5	21-Jun-26 19:19:33	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	83.03

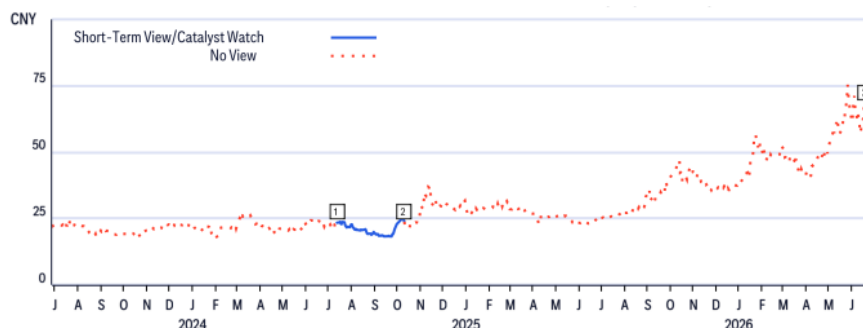
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

TongFu Microelectronics (002156.SZ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	12-Jul-24 08:05:30	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	23.40
2	10-Oct-24 23:26:20	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	23.74
3	21-Jun-26 19:19:33	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	68.27

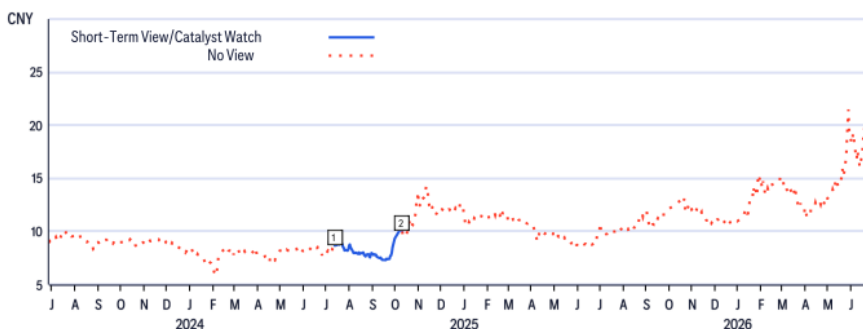
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tianshui Huatian (002185.SZ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kevin Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	12-Jul-24 09:43:52	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	8.67
2	10-Oct-24 23:26:15	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	10.00

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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